

Day 3 — The Magic Word

Module: Friends to Ten (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children meet the Sanskrit word *Nikhilam*. They learn to pronounce it, recognise the wall poster, and connect it to “friends to ten.”

Materials

- A new wall poster: the word **Nikhilam** in big letters, with a smiling face. Underneath, in small letters: “the friend rule.”
- Drawing paper
- Crayons

The flow

Settle + chant (5 min)

The friends-to-ten chant, 3 times.

The magic-word story (10 min)

The Sanskrit Word

Long ago, people in India had a special name for “the friend rule.” The name is a Sanskrit word.

(Pause for suspense.)

Are you ready?

The word is — **Nikhilam!** *(Say it slowly: ni-khi-lam.)*

(Class echoes 3 times. Soft / normal / loud. Children find it funny — let them.)

Nikhilam means “all of it” or “the whole.” It’s the secret name for our friends-to-ten rule.

An older book from 1965 gives this rule a fancy name. We’ll learn the long name in Grade 6. For today — just say *Nikhilam*. The friend rule. The whole. All of it.

Drawing time (15 min)

Each child draws ONE friend-pair. Above the pair, write the word **NIKHILAM** in big letters (or use the wall poster as a guide).

Examples: a pair of trees labelled “3 and 7.” Two children holding hands labelled “4 and 6.” Two suns labelled “5 and 5.”

(Teacher walks around helping with the spelling of “Nikhilam.”)

Sharing (5 min)

3 children hold up their drawings. Class chorus the friend-pair AND chants *Nikhilam* together.

End with the daily chant + one big “*NIKHILAM!*”

Homework / take-home

- Tell a parent the magic word: *Nikhilam*. Say it 5 times. Win their amazement.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Try to write *Nikhilam* in Devanāgarī (निखिलं). Provide a print-out card.
- **Tier down:** Just say the word. Drawing is optional.

Teacher’s quick notes

- The pronunciation is harder than it looks. Model slowly. Don’t correct individual children publicly — they’ll get it by Day 6 through repetition.
- Some children will ask “what does it mean?” Answer: “all” or “the whole” or “every part.” The full meaning becomes clear in Middle band.
- This is the first Sanskrit word many children will say with confidence. Honour it. Some will go home and say it 200 times.

Citation(s) used (teacher reference, not student-facing)

- Tirthaji, *Vedic Mathematics* (1965), sūtra Nikhilam.